ODOO

Implementation Cycle Guide

End-to-End Project Methodology | Version 2.0 | April 2026

This guide defines the complete Odoo ERP implementation lifecycle — from initial project kick-off through post-go-live support. It establishes the activities, deliverables, roles, and best practices for each phase, ensuring a structured, on-time, and on-budget deployment.

8	40+	20+	360°
Phases	Activities	Deliverables	Coverage

Implementation Phases

Phase 1 Duration: 1–2 Weeks

Project Initiation & Kick-Off

Overview

The Initiation phase establishes the foundation for the entire project. The implementation team and client stakeholders align on scope, objectives, timeline, resources, and governance before any technical work begins.

1.1 Key Activities

- Hold the **Project Kick-Off Meeting** with all stakeholders
- Define and sign the **Project Charter** and Scope of Work (SOW)
- Identify and assign the **Project Team** — consultant, client PM, key users
- Establish the **Communication Plan** — meeting cadence, reporting, escalation
- Set up the **Project Management Tool** (Odoo Project, Jira, Monday)
- Conduct initial **Infrastructure Assessment** — hosting, server, network
- Agree on the **Project Schedule** with milestones and deadlines
- Define **Success Criteria** and KPIs for the project

1.2 Project Charter Contents

Section	Description
Project Name & Code	Unique identifier for tracking and billing
Project Objectives	SMART goals the implementation must achieve
Scope	Modules, entities, countries, and integrations included
Out of Scope	Explicitly excluded items to prevent scope creep
Timeline & Milestones	Phase dates, UAT date, go-live date
Budget	Fixed-price or T&M; payment schedule
Team & Roles	Named contacts on both sides with responsibilities
Risks & Assumptions	Known risks and assumptions the plan is based on
Sign-Off	Client and partner signatures before phase 2 begins

Key Deliverables
• Signed Project Charter
• Project Schedule (Gantt chart)
• Communication & Escalation Plan
• Team Contact Directory
• Infrastructure Assessment Report

NOTE Never proceed to Phase 2 without a signed Project Charter. Undefined scope is the #1 cause of Odoo project overruns.

Phase 2 Duration: 2–3 Weeks

Business Analysis & Requirements

Overview

The Analysis phase maps current business processes (As-Is) and defines the desired future state (To-Be). The output drives all configuration and development decisions in subsequent phases.

2.1 Discovery Workshops

Conduct structured workshops for each business area to be implemented:

Workshop	Participants	Duration	Output
Sales & CRM	Sales Manager, Sales Reps	3–4 hrs	Sales process flowchart
Purchase	Procurement Manager	2–3 hrs	Procurement cycle map
Inventory	Warehouse Manager, Stock Clerks	3–4 hrs	Warehouse flow diagram
Accounting	CFO, Accountants	4–5 hrs	Chart of accounts, tax setup
HR & Payroll	HR Manager, Payroll Officer	3–4 hrs	Employee lifecycle map
Manufacturing	Production Manager	3–4 hrs	BOM & routing structure
IT & Integrations	IT Manager	2–3 hrs	Integration architecture

2.2 Gap Analysis

Compare As-Is processes against Odoo standard capabilities to identify gaps:

- **Standard Fit** — Odoo covers the requirement out-of-the-box
- **Configuration Gap** — Requirement met by configuring Odoo settings
- **Customisation Gap** — Requires custom module development
- **Process Change** — Client process must be adapted to Odoo best practice
- **Integration Gap** — Requires connecting Odoo to a third-party system via API

TIP Encourage process change over customisation wherever possible. Custom code increases cost, maintenance burden, and upgrade complexity.

2.3 Business Requirements Document

- Executive Summary & Project Context
- Current State (As-Is) and Future State (To-Be) Process Maps
- Functional Requirements — one row per requirement with priority (Must/Should/Could)
- Non-Functional Requirements — performance, security, availability
- Gap Analysis Matrix with resolution approach for each gap
- Data Migration Requirements — legacy systems, volumes, cleansing rules
- Integration Requirements — APIs, file formats, frequency
- Reporting Requirements — list of needed reports and dashboards

Key Deliverables
• Business Requirements Document (BRD)
• As-Is & To-Be Process Maps
• Gap Analysis Matrix
• Data Migration Plan (initial)
• Integration Architecture Diagram
• Module Scope Confirmation

Phase 3 Duration: 2–4 Weeks

Solution Design & Architecture

Overview

Design translates business requirements into a detailed technical blueprint. Every configuration decision and development item is documented before any code is written or setting changed.

3.1 Functional Design Document (FDD)

- Module-by-module configuration specifications
- Custom field definitions — model, name, type, default value
- Workflow and automated action specifications
- Access rights matrix — group, model, CRUD permissions
- Report templates and print layout designs
- Email template designs and trigger conditions
- Dashboard and KPI widget specifications

3.2 Technical Design Document (TDD)

Required for any custom development items identified in the gap analysis:

- Custom module architecture and dependencies
- Data model extensions — new models or inherited models
- Business logic specifications — Python methods, ORM operations
- API integration design — endpoints, authentication, data mapping
- Migration scripts — source fields mapped to Odoo destination fields

3.3 Data Migration Design

Data Object	Source	Volume	Method	Owner
Customers / Contacts	Legacy CRM / Excel	5,000+	CSV Import	Consultant
Products & Variants	ERP / Excel	2,000+	CSV Import	Consultant
Chart of Accounts	Accounting System	500+	CSV Import	Accountant
Opening Balances	Accounting System	All	Journal Entry	Accountant

Data Object	Source	Volume	Method	Owner
Inventory Stock	WMS / Excel	All	Inventory Adj.	Warehouse Mgr
Employees	HR System	All	CSV Import	HR Manager

Key Deliverables

- Functional Design Document (FDD)
- Technical Design Document (TDD)
- Data Migration Mapping Sheet
- Integration Technical Specification
- Test Plan (initial draft)
- FDD Sign-Off by Client

WARNING Do not start Phase 4 development without a client-signed FDD. Unsigned designs lead to rework and billing disputes.

Phase 4 Duration: 4–8 Weeks

Development & Configuration

Overview

This is the longest phase. The consultant configures standard Odoo to match the approved FDD and developers build custom modules in a dedicated Development environment.

4.1 Environment Strategy

Environment	Purpose	Who Has Access	Data
Development (DEV)	Active configuration & custom code	Consultants only	Sample / dummy data
Staging / UAT	Client testing and sign-off	Consultants + Key Users	Sanitised real data
Production (PROD)	Live business operations	All users	Real data only

4.2 Configuration Sequence

Area	Key Settings
Company Settings	Name, logo, address, currency, fiscal year, timezone
Chart of Accounts	Import accounts, journals, tax positions
Warehouses & Locations	Warehouse structure, routes, putaway rules
Products	Categories, units of measure, pricelists
Users & Access Rights	Create users, assign groups, configure record rules
Email Configuration	SMTP server, alias domain, email templates
Sales Configuration	Payment terms, pricelists, invoice policy
Purchase Configuration	Vendor lead times, purchase agreements, 3-way match
Accounting Periods	Fiscal year, lock dates, tax periods
HR Structure	Departments, job positions, working schedules, leave types

4.3 Custom Development Workflow

- **Step 1 — Branch:** Create a feature branch in Git
- **Step 2 — Develop:** Write code following Odoo standards; include unit tests
- **Step 3 — Code Review:** Peer review; check security and performance
- **Step 4 — Merge:** Merge to development branch after approval
- **Step 5 — Deploy to DEV:** Deploy and smoke-test on development environment
- **Step 6 — Deploy to UAT:** Deploy to staging for client validation

TIP Use Odoo.sh or a CI/CD pipeline to automate deployments to DEV and UAT, reducing manual errors and saving time.

Key Deliverables

- Configured DEV environment matching FDD
- Custom modules deployed and tested
- Data migration scripts (dry run)
- Integration connectors built and tested
- Internal consultant testing sign-off

Phase 5 Duration: 2–3 Weeks

Testing & Quality Assurance

Overview

Testing validates that the configured system meets all requirements before go-live. Multiple test types are executed in sequence, with issues tracked and resolved before proceeding.

5.1 Testing Types

Test Type	Performed By	When	Pass Criteria
Unit Testing	Developer	During development	Each function works in isolation
System Integration	Consultant	End of DEV phase	All modules and integrations pass
UAT	Key Users	On UAT environment	All BRD requirements confirmed
Performance	Consultant + IT	Before go-live	Response < 3 sec; 50+ concurrent users
Regression	Consultant	After any bug fix	Previously passing tests still pass
Data Migration	Consultant + Users	UAT phase	Data counts match; no corruption

5.2 UAT Process

- Prepare **Test Scripts** — step-by-step scenarios from the BRD
- Load UAT with sanitised production-like data
- Users record results as **Pass**, **Fail**, or **Blocked**
- Log all failures in the defect tracker with screenshots
- Consultant triages: **Bug** (fix), **Enhancement** (backlog), **User Error** (training)
- UAT complete when **zero Critical/High defects** remain open

5.3 Defect Severity

Severity	Definition	SLA	Go-Live Blocker?
Critical	System crash, data loss, complete process blockage	24 hrs	YES

Severity	Definition	SLA	Go-Live Blocker?
High	Core process cannot be completed	48 hrs	YES
Medium	Process works with a workaround	1 week	NO
Low	Minor UI / cosmetic defect	Next release	NO

Key Deliverables

- Test Plan & Test Scripts
- UAT Completion Report
- Defect Log (all Critical/High closed)
- Performance Test Results
- Data Migration Test Report
- UAT Sign-Off Form

WARN Never go live with open Critical or High defects. A failed go-live is far more costly than a delayed one.

Phase 6 Duration: 1–2 Weeks

Training & Change Management

Overview

Training ensures all users can operate Odoo confidently on go-live day. Change management addresses the human side of the transition and dramatically reduces post-launch support tickets.

6.1 Training Plan

Audience	Training Type	Duration	Delivered By
System Admin	Technical admin — config, backup, users	Full day	Senior Consultant
Key Users / Trainers	Role-based functional training per module	Half day each	Consultant
End Users	Task-based hands-on sessions	2–4 hrs	Key User (train-the-trainer)
Management	Dashboard, reporting, KPI overview	1–2 hrs	Consultant
IT Team	Server management, monitoring, deployment	Half day	Consultant

6.2 Training Materials

- **User Manuals** — Step-by-step guides per role
- **Quick Reference Cards** — One-page cheat sheets for daily tasks
- **Video Recordings** — Screen recordings of key workflows
- **FAQ Document** — Compiled from UAT and training sessions

6.3 Change Management

- Identify and engage **Change Champions** in each department early
- Communicate the **Why** — benefits to users personally
- Involve key users in UAT so they feel ownership of the system
- Have a **Help Desk channel** ready on Day 1
- Schedule **post-go-live floor walks** for 2–3 days after launch

TIP Train on the UAT environment using real company data so training feels authentic and users gain genuine confidence.

Key Deliverables
• Training Plan & Schedule
• User Manuals (per role)
• Quick Reference Cards
• Training Attendance Records
• Go-Live Readiness Assessment

Phase 7 Duration: 1 Week

Go-Live & Cutover

Overview

Go-Live is the carefully orchestrated transition from legacy systems to Odoo in production. A detailed cutover plan ensures data integrity, minimal downtime, and a confident team on Day 1.

7.1 Go-Live Checklist

#	Task	Owner	Done?
1	Production server provisioned and hardened	IT Team	
2	SSL certificate installed and HTTPS enforced	IT Team	
3	Nginx / reverse proxy configured	IT Team	
4	Master password set; database manager secured	Consultant	
5	Email server (SMTP) tested in production	Consultant	
6	All users created with correct access rights	Consultant	
7	Final data migration executed and verified	Consultant	
8	Opening balances posted and reviewed by accountant	Accountant	
9	Inventory stock loaded and counted	Warehouse Mgr	
10	Legacy system access restricted	IT Team	
11	Backup schedule configured; first backup verified	IT Team	
12	Help desk channel open and staffed	Project Manager	
13	Go-Live sign-off obtained from client sponsor	Client PM	

7.2 Cutover Strategy Options

Strategy	Description	Risk	Best For
Big Bang	All modules go live simultaneously	High	Small/medium businesses
Phased	Modules deployed in waves	Medium	Large organisations
Parallel Run	Legacy and Odoo run together for 1–4 weeks	Low	High-risk accounting migrations
Pilot	One department / location goes live first	Low	Multi-branch businesses

WARN Schedule go-live at the START of a business cycle. Avoid go-live mid-month or within 60 days of fiscal year-end.

Key Deliverables

- Completed Go-Live Checklist
- Final Data Migration Validation Report
- Production Environment Sign-Off
- Go-Live Communication to all users
- Day-1 Issue Log
- Go-Live Certificate (signed by client)

Phase 8 Duration: 4–8 Weeks

Post Go-Live Support & Optimisation

Overview

The Support phase stabilises the system, closes outstanding items, and transitions the client to self-sufficient operation while capturing optimisation opportunities discovered through real production use.

8.1 Hypercare (Weeks 1–4)

- Daily issue review and priority triage meeting
- All Critical and High issues resolved within SLA
- Monitor server — CPU, RAM, disk, query response times
- Conduct **user adoption check** — confirm all users are active
- Identify power users for advanced training

8.2 Support SLA Tiers

Priority	Response	Resolution	Example
P1 — Critical	30 min	4 hrs	System down; cannot process orders or invoices
P2 — High	2 hrs	1 business day	Core workflow blocked, no workaround
P3 — Medium	4 hrs	3 business days	Issue has a workaround available
P4 — Low	1 day	Next sprint	Cosmetic issues, enhancement requests

8.3 Project Closure

- Conduct **Project Retrospective** — what went well, what to improve
- Hand over **System Documentation** — admin guide, configuration record
- Transfer all credentials — admin passwords, server, domain registrar
- Offer **Annual Maintenance Agreement** for ongoing support
- Schedule 30-day and 90-day **health check calls**

Key Deliverables

- Hypercare Issue Log — all P1/P2 items closed
- System Administration Guide

- Credential Handover Document
- Project Closure Report
- Client Satisfaction Survey
- Ongoing Support / Maintenance Contract (optional)

RACI Matrix — Key Activities

R = Responsible A = Accountable C = Consulted I = Informed

Task / Activity	Consultant	Client PM	IT Team	End Users	Management
Project Charter Sign-Off	R	A	I	I	C
Business Requirements Workshops	R	A	C	C	I
FDD / TDD Sign-Off	R	A	I	I	C
Configuration & Development	R	I	C	I	I
UAT Execution	C	A	I	R	I
UAT Sign-Off	I	A	I	R	C
Data Migration Execution	R	A	C	I	I
User Training Delivery	R	C	I	R	I
Go-Live Decision	C	A	C	I	R
Production Environment Setup	C	I	R	I	I
Post Go-Live Support	R	A	C	I	I

Appendix

Risk Register & Critical Success Factors

A.1 Project Risk Register

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Scope creep beyond SOW	High	High	Strict change control; all changes need written approval
Key client resource unavailable	Medium	High	Identify backup contacts; build buffer into schedule
Data quality issues in legacy system	High	High	Data audit in Phase 2; cleansing before migration
Resistance to change from users	Medium	Medium	Change champions; involve users early in UAT
Third-party integration delays	Medium	High	Start integration design in Phase 2; use mock APIs
Custom development overrun	Medium	High	Fixed-price custom items; code review checkpoints
Server / infrastructure not ready	Low	High	Infrastructure checklist signed off in Phase 1
Go-Live during peak business period	Low	High	Agree go-live window at project start; include in charter

A.2 Critical Success Factors

- **Executive Sponsorship** — Senior champion with authority to resolve blockers
- **Dedicated Client PM** — Single point of accountability; min. 50% time allocation
- **Available Key Users** — Business experts participate in workshops, UAT, and training
- **Signed Approvals at Every Phase Gate** — No phase begins without written sign-off
- **Realistic Scope** — Phased approach preferred; quick wins build confidence
- **Clean Data from Day One** — Legacy data audit and cleansing before migration
- **Process Before Technology** — Process decisions made before Odoo is configured
- **Stick to Standard Odoo** — Customise only where business justification is clear
- **Test Everything** — 100% of BRD requirements must have a test script
- **Post Go-Live Commitment** — Budget and resources allocated for hypercare period

A successful Odoo implementation is not just about software — it is about people, process, and partnership. Follow this methodology phase by phase, secure sign-offs at every gate, keep the user at the centre of every decision, and your project will deliver measurable business value from Day 1.